

Sarayu Ramnath | Curriculum Vitae

EDUCATION

Master of Environmental Science and Management (Expected June 2026)

Bren School of Environmental Science & Management – University of California, Santa Barbara (UCSB)

Specialization: Coastal Resource Management | **Focus:** Environmental Communication

Highlighted Coursework: Environmental Writing, Coastal Policy, Environmental Policy, Marine Conservation and Management, Environmental Law, Advanced Data Analysis, GIS.

Extracurricular Activities: KCSB Radio, Career Development Student Assistant, marine debris and plant restoration volunteer (Channel Islands National Park).

Bachelor of Science, Animal Science (March 2017)

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

POLICY & COMMUNICATION EXPERIENCE

Co-Project Manager & Data Manager | Environmental Baseline Assessment of Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary - Master's Group Project, Santa Barbara, CA (4/25 – 6/26)

- Co-authored a 150-page evidence-based management report for Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary, synthesizing historical oceanographic, biodiversity, and human-use data to inform sanctuary management decisions for staff, scientists, and rightsholders.
- Co-led project coordination and data infrastructure; facilitated team meetings, brought in external guidance to advance analysis and reporting, and recruited and mentored an undergraduate data intern.
- Consolidated and analyzed 30+ years of seabird and marine mammal survey data; executed data quality and spatio-temporal analyses in species richness and community composition.
- Organized data and workflow repository structure; guided project teammates on version control and documentation; developed reproducible workflows and metadata organization; created publication-ready visualizations and written materials for technical and public audiences.

Environmental Communications Capstone | UCSB Natural Reserve System, Santa Barbara, CA (3/26–6/26)

- Developed a suite of data visualizations and redesigned infographic materials communicating UCSB Natural Reserve System as a statewide network supporting research, education, and public service.
- Analyzed institutional data to identify key indicators for public-facing communication and created a reporting workflow enabling annual updates.
- Collaborated with reserve directors and institutional partners to contextualize system-level data, ensuring visualizations accurately reflect on-the-ground perspectives for public and partner audiences.

Channel Islands Marine Debris Cleanup Coordinator | National Marine Sanctuary Foundation (NMSF), Ventura, CA (8/23–12/23)

- Coordinated Northern Channel Islands marine debris cleanups through interagency collaboration with NMSF, Channel Islands National Marine Sanctuary (CINMS), local conservation partners, and fishermen.
- Established an internal ArcGIS mapping protocol for ongoing marine debris cleanup tracking; authored project summary used in grant situation reports for NMSF and CINMS.
- Developed public outreach strategy for CINMS balloon pollution campaign, curating existing assets into a sequenced posting schedule with platform strategy and partnership tagging.

Social Media Coordinator | Point Blue Conservation Science, Petaluma, CA (9/20–7/22)

- Developed public outreach strategies and produced original content across Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, and Twitter; tracked and analyzed engagement metrics to inform content decisions, doubling followers, engagement, and reach within 6 months.
- Collaborated with scientists, community organizations, and agency partners across multiple programs to translate conservation research into accessible content for broad public audiences.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Associate | Conservation International, Santa Barbara, CA (11/24–Present)

- Co-author climate vulnerability assessment for 11 marine megafauna species in Eastern Tropical Pacific, contributing to overall synthesis structure, section-by-section drafting, policy-oriented recommendations, and revisions.
- Support international project coordination including facilitating meetings, managing data use agreements, and presenting findings to donors, partners, and research collaborators across climate modeling and taxonomic expert teams.
- Conduct spatial vulnerability mapping to identify high-risk habitats and visualize the overlap of species distribution and anthropogenic pressures across study regions.

Marine Ecology Research Assistant | Point Blue Conservation Science & affiliated agencies, California & Baja California Sur (2017-2022)

- Conducted laboratory and field research on marine predator population dynamics and seabird breeding productivity, contributing to long-term monitoring programs supporting management decisions across Greater Farallones and Cordell Bank National Marine Sanctuaries.
- Supported field operations on the Farallon Islands in coordination with U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service; provided on-island interpretation for visiting researchers and patrol volunteers.
- Developed maps and figures contributing to a U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service census report on Pacific black brant winter population trends; coordinated with México-based partners on cross-border shorebird research.

REPORTS & PRESENTATIONS

Ramnath S., Gonzales L., Brito-Morales I., Hannah L., et al. *Save the Blue 5 Climate Vulnerability Assessment for Marine Megafauna in the Eastern Tropical Pacific*. Conservation International, 2026. In review.

Hatfield M., **Ramnath S.**, Smith C., Graham M., Castillo A. *Baseline Environmental Assessment of Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary*. Bren School of Environmental Science & Management, 2026. Forthcoming. DOI: 10.5061/dryad.zpc866tqm.

CalCOFI Conference, San Diego, California – May 2026

Oceanography and Marine Megafauna in Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary (poster)

Species on the Move, Rìyuè tán, Taiwan – April 2026

A Synthesis of Climate-Driven Distribution Shifts in Eastern Pacific Megafauna

American Geophysical Union, New Orleans, Louisiana – December 2025

Building Inclusive Team Frameworks in Cryosphere Research: Reflections from the Field (poster)

Center for Alaskan Coastal Studies, Homer, Alaska – August 2025

Collaborative Research and Public Data to Understand a Dynamic Pacific

GRANTS AND AWARDS

UCSB Graduate Division Individualized Professional Skills Grant, \$1200– 2026 (pending)

Species on the Move Young Scholar Award, \$625–2026

Bren Special Opportunities Fund \$1200– 2025

MPA Collaborative Network Early Career Scholarship \$1300– 2024

UCSB Bren School Student Recruitment Fellowship, \$31,704– 2024-2025

SKILLS

Policy & Communication: Technical and public writing, community and partner engagement, public speaking, interagency coordination.

Science Communication & Engagement: Hootsuite, Affinity Designer, Mailchimp.

GIS & Spatial Analysis: ArcGIS, QGIS.

Data Management & Computing: Microsoft Access, Git/GitHub, R/RStudio, Quarto.

Languages: Spanish (proficient).